



Whither Critique?

2023 01 12





Agenda

✓ Typical purposes

✓ WIFY

✓ WIFM

✓ HMW?





Typical purposes of design critique

Evaluative

- Does the design meet business objectives
- Does the design meet user needs
- Is the design feasible
- Is the design ready

Team: Squad+

Approval-oriented

Developmental

- How might the design be improved
- What alternatives are available
- What tools or techniques might be employed
- What information would be of use
- Does the design meet business objectives
- Does the design meet user needs

Team: UX

Process/improvement-oriented



What's in it for you, ideally (WIFY)

- Help thinking about the parts that are hard
- Help noticing where your work relates to work on other teams
- Mutual aid and support as a habit
- Sharing as a habit
- Ego safety

Most of these contribute to “teaminess”



What's in it for me, ideally (WIFM)

- Provide **the same coaching to everyone**
- Witness the work and progress across squads
- Notice and reinforce the works' relationship to objectives and strategy



How might we meet these aims? (HIMW)

- People volunteer to present?
- Everyone presents every week?
- Something else?

DESIGN
CRITIQUE:
DO I **HAVE** TO?



FEAR NOT.



You'll come to love it.

1.

WHAT IT IS

GROUP CONVERSATION TO HELP IMPROVE A DESIGN

- Periodic
- Participatory
- Expected
- Constructive, helpful
- Conversation
- About the work
- Work in progress
- Open

■ BENEFITS

- Borrow the good thinking of others to help your projects
- See what others are doing
- Directors gain a sense of the pulse of projects

2.

WHAT IT IS NOT

■ NOT CRITIQUE

- Optional
- “FYI here’s the design”
- HPPO-driven
- Approval
- Personal
- Pointed

3.

HOW TO PARTICIPATE

■ PRESENTER

- Set the stage (quickly)
 - Where I am in the project
 - Design goals for the work
- Show and tell
 - Here it is, what I'm thinking about
 - What I need feedback on
- Leave space for participant responses
- Listen

■ PARTICIPANT

- Listen
- Ask clarifying questions
- Consider the work against its objectives
- Talk about the work, not the person
- Offer possibilities

4.

OTHER DETAILS

■ DO I HAVE TO BE **FIRST**?

Nope. We will randomize the order of presenters. Each presenter will have a set timeframe to present.

WHAT IF I DON'T HAVE SOMETHING TO SHOW?

You probably have something to show.

Comfort will improve with practice.

WHAT IF MY WORK IS **NOT READY TO SHOW?**

Your work is “ready to show” at any stage. You can be helped by the group at any stage.

(With rare exceptions)

qco?

Presenter

- Set the stage
 - Where I am in the project
 - Objectives for the work
- Show and tell
 - Here it is, what I'm thinking about
 - What I need feedback on
- Leave space for participant responses
- Listen

Participant

- Listen
- Ask clarifying questions
- Consider the work against its objectives
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- Periodic
- Participatory
- Constructive, helpful
- Conversation
- About the work
- Work in progress
- Expected
- Open

- Randomized
- Timeboxed